CHAPTER 7 · TONES & SEMITONES

Lesson Book draft v2 + review pack

New in v2 (your 09:35 choice): the picture is the step the names already say. A semitone is a **half step** (반음 = 반 걸음) -- to the very next key; a tone is a **whole step** (온음 = 온 걸음) -- two half steps, one key in between. Both pairs of names are taught: semitone and tone (Australian and British books), half step and whole step (American books). Chapter 3's letter steps are either whole or half. "As close as a best friend" stays as one phrase on page 2. It also uses what you already decided: the keyboard street of chapter 2 (the small house and the big house), chapter 3's residents (Clara C, her Dog D, the Exit E, the Front door F, Grandma G, her Apple garden A, the Back door B), the bird's sky and the turtle's sea for up and down, and chapter 6's "the same key, two ways". It follows the Book rules: one idea per page, nothing twice, set tasks, big and full pages.

AMEB (checked in the 2026 Manual): Music Craft Preliminary -- recognise and write the sharp and flat. Grade 1 -- the sharp, flat and natural signs, the ideas "enharmonic" and "chromatic", tones and semitones marked on scales. Theory of Music Grade 1 -- the sharp, flat and natural, and where the tones and semitones fall in C, G and F major. Double sharps and flats: Grade 4 in both. Piano for Leisure Grade 1 technical work has a chromatic scale, hands separately.

The draft, 7 pages: 1 Clara on the keyboard street: two half steps make a whole step · 2 A half step: a semitone (the very next key, black or white) · 3 A whole step: a tone (two half steps, one key between) · 4 White half steps: E F and B C (the Exit and the Front door; the Back door and Clara) · 5 Sharp and flat: one key, two names (C♯ = D♭ …) · 6 Sharps and flats on the staff (just before the note, on its line or space; Queensland and Kingsland) · 7 My five checks.

How to answer: reply with codes, e.g. "B1 yes, B5 a, A2 ok". Yellow marks in the draft (B3, B4, B5, B8) show the lines that wait for your answers. B1 is settled.

Three questions for the public guide page

G1 When your students meet tones and semitones, what goes wrong most often? (My guesses: counting the key they start on as a step; calling every white-key neighbour a tone, even E F and B C; thinking a black key has only one name; writing the sign after the note, or on the wrong line.)

G2 The half step / whole step picture is the heart of the chapter. Is there anything you always say or do with it in a lesson that the page should catch?

G3 One tip for parents: what should five minutes at home look like? (My suggestion: the half-step walk from C to C, then naming the black keys both ways.)

What's in this pack

A · what today's chapter 7 does · B · your decisions, each with my recommendation · the 7 draft pages · today's online lesson and Workbook, for comparison.

A · What today's chapter 7 does

Today chapter 7 is an online lesson in three steps (semitones and tones; accidentals; the chromatic scale and double sharps), a drill with 4 levels, and a Workbook and Teacher copy from Phase 298, made before the Book rules. There is no Lesson Book yet.

A1 The online lesson is not a Lesson Book on screen. It is cards, tips and tools in three long steps. After your OK it becomes the book on screen, like chapters 1-6.

A2 It teaches double sharps and the chromatic scale written out with its fingering. Those are Grade 4-5 topics in a Preliminary chapter. Its tip also says E♯ = F and C♭ = B.

A3 "An accidental lasts until the bar line" comes before bar lines are taught. The rhythm stage starts right after this chapter.

A4 "Half step" and "whole step" sit next to semitone and tone on the cards, with no picture. v2 keeps both names and makes the step the picture (B1).

A5 The drill: level 1 mixes everything at once; level 3 is two names for one key; level 4 is chapter 3's old "name the black keys" level. No level reads the signs on the staff.

A6 The Workbook and Teacher copy (Phase 298) were made before the Book rules. They have faces drawn on the keys, a "map for this chapter" page, a drill page, and a check-up with a score.

A7 The townhouse map calls this room "Sharps & flats", while the chapter is "Tones & Semitones".

A8 All books: a double dash "--" can break across two lines. Here it splits as "them -" / "- best friends", and your chapter 6 photo shows "lands -" / "- up". I'll glue the dash to the word before it, in every book.

Checked by a second reviewer (on draft v1)

A separate reviewer checked every key, black-key name, heart, arrow and staff position in English and Korean, and checked the pages against the Book rules. All the music was right. I applied these fixes from its list:

- "A **sharp** ♯" read like the note A♯, so it now says "the sharp sign ♯". In Korean, ♯는 (not ♯은).
- Layout: the Dog covered his own letter, the hearts touched the letters, the two captions ran together, and the check icon was clipped.
- The natural ♮ only makes sense with a bar line, so it is out of the draft for now (B6).
- A set task, not "your teacher plays two keys": the pairs are printed (C D, E F, B C, F G, G♯ A♯, D♯ E).
- Wording: "Almost every key has two best friends" (the lowest and the highest key have one); "your best friend's other best friend"; "count the steps, not the keys".
- Bigger hops and hearts, taller keyboards, a one-line REMEMBER, and Korean verbs and particles.

Waiting on you, so not changed: Korean line breaks inside words (the keep-all question, app-wide).

B · Your decisions

B1 **Settled (09:35):** semitone = half step = 반음 = 반 걸음; tone = whole step = 온음 = 온 걸음. Both pairs of names in the book; the drill and the Workbook take either name as right.

B2 **The opener:** Clara at her C takes two half steps -- to the black key, then on to D -- and they make one whole step. Footprints mark where each step lands (coral half, navy whole).
Rec yes.

B3 **The white best friends, told with chapter 3's residents:** walk out of the Exit (E) straight to the Front door (F); out of the Back door (B) to Princess Clara (C).
Rec yes. It also gets the scales chapter ready: tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone.

B4 **One black key, two names** (C♯ = D♭): "a half step up from Clara's C, and a half step down from the Dog's D", like chapter 6's "the same key, two ways". The word "enharmonic" (Music Craft Grade 1) goes only in the Teacher copy.
Rec yes.

B5 **How to remember the signs:** (a) just the step: ♯ up a half step, ♭ down a half step; (b) add a picture: a flat tyre goes down; (c) your own.
Rec (a). One picture per idea, and the half step is already the picture.

B6 **The natural** ♮ is in Music Craft Grade 1 and Theory Grade 1; Preliminary asks only for ♯ and ♭. Without bar lines it has nothing to cancel.
Rec teach it together with "a sign lasts until the bar line", once the rhythm stage has drawn bar lines. The other way: keep it here, with one bar line drawn.

B7 **What waits for later:** double sharps and flats (Grade 4), writing the chromatic scale (Music Craft Grade 5), E♯ B♯ F♭ C♭ (the scales chapters), tone-and-a-half (harmonic minor).
Rec take them out of chapter 7's book and drill. Their tools stay in the Toolbox.

B8 **The half-step walk** at the piano on page 2: every key from C to C, 12 half steps. It is the chromatic scale (Piano for Leisure Grade 1, hands separately).
Rec do the walk; the word "chromatic" goes only in the Teacher copy.

B9 **Drill levels**, one idea each: 1 half step or whole step? (two keys lit; either name is right) · 2 play a half step, up or down · 3 play a whole step, up or down · 4 E F and B C: half or whole between white neighbours · 5 name the black keys (sharp or flat) · 6 one key, two names · 7 sharps and flats on the staff → the key (Queensland, then Kingsland).
Rec these 7.

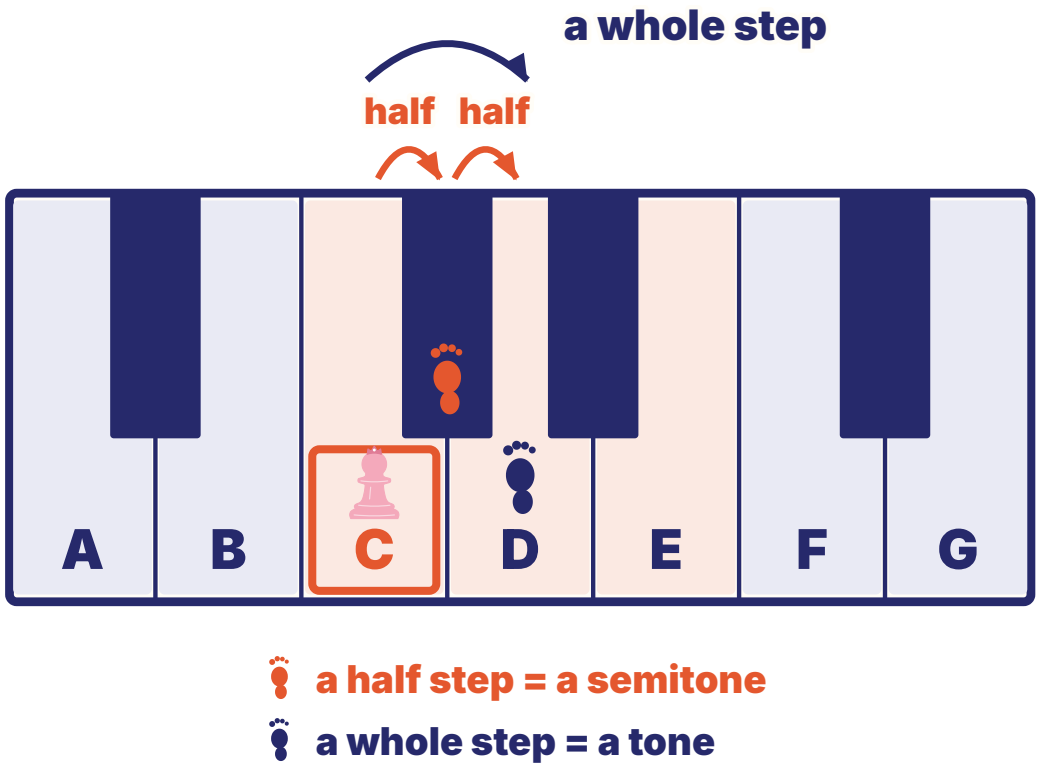
B10 **Workbook ideas** (set tasks a child can do alone, built after the book): W1 draw the half step up and down from set keys (D, a black key, E, B) · W2 draw the whole step from set keys, up or down as the arrow says · W3 half or whole? Write H or W under white neighbours, and circle E F and B C · W4 name the black keys both ways; draw the arrow, sharp up or flat down · W5 draw a set sign before set notes on the staff; name the sharps and flats and colour the key · last page: the check-up on paper.
Rec all six.

B11 **The opener:** minimal, as in chapters 4-6: the keyboard street, Clara at C, two half steps and the whole step they make.
Rec keep it.

CHAPTER 7

Tones & Semitones

The names tell you the size. A **semitone** is a **half step** -- to the very next key. A **tone** is a **whole step** -- two half steps. And the black keys get their names: **sharps** and **flats**.



In this chapter

- [ ] A half step: a semitone 2
- [ ] A whole step: a tone 3
- [ ] White half steps 4
- [ ] Sharp and flat 5
- [ ] Sharps and flats on the staff 6
- [ ] My five checks 7

By the end, you can

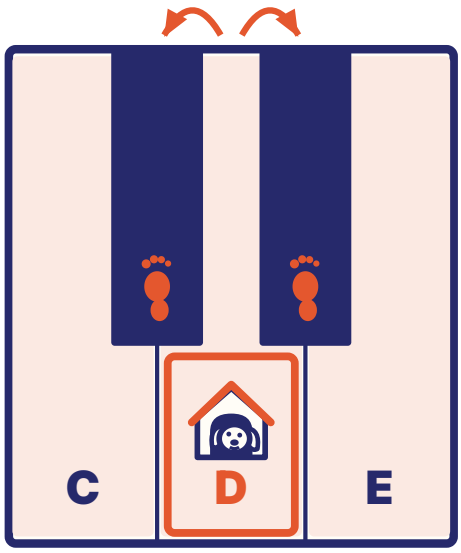
- [ ] play a half step up and down from any key
- [ ] play a whole step up and down from any key
- [ ] show the white half steps: E F and B C
- [ ] name every black key two ways: C♯ = D♭
- [ ] read sharps and flats on the staff and play them

online

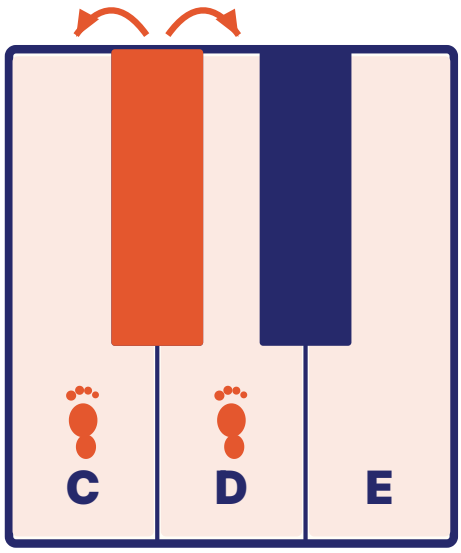
STEP 1

A half step: a semitone

The smallest step on the piano is a **half step**: from a key to the **very next key** -- black or white, nothing in between, as close as a best friend. Its other name is a **semitone** (*semi* means half): Australian and British books say semitone, American books say half step -- the same step. A half step goes up to the right, towards the bird's sky, or down to the left, towards the turtle's sea.



The Dog's half steps:
two black keys



A black key's half steps:
two white keys

At the piano

1. Put a finger on D, the Dog. Play a half step up, then a half step down -- both black keys. Say "half step" each time. ☐

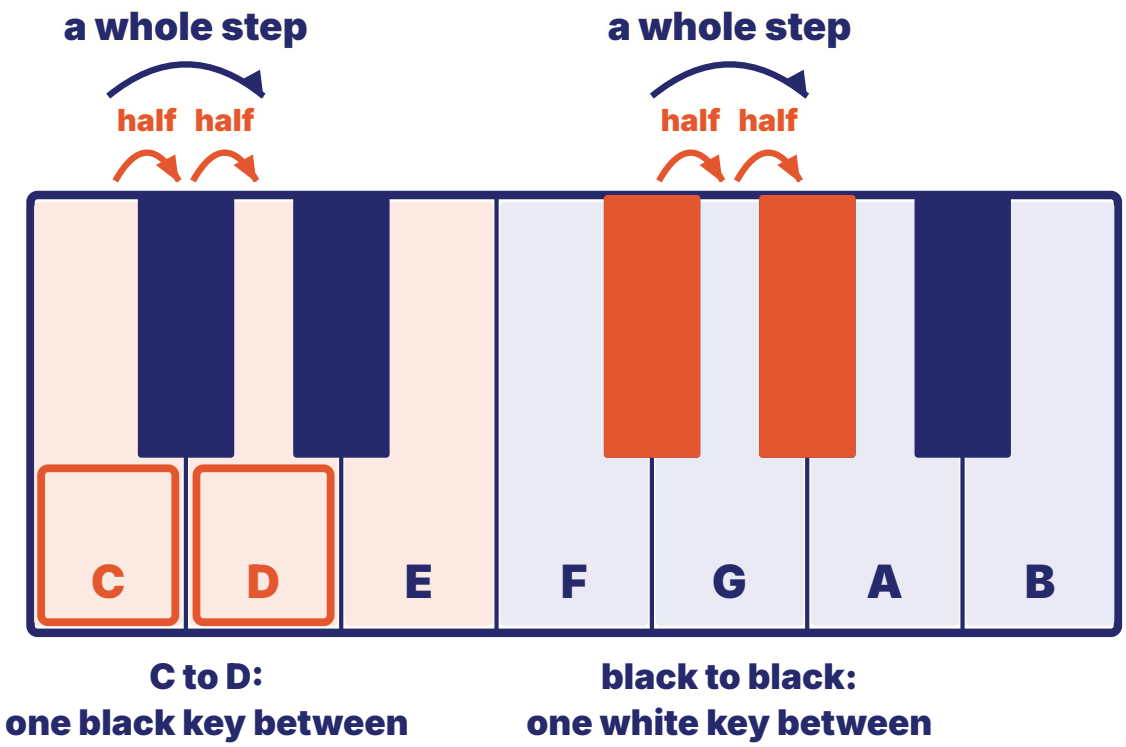
2. B8 **The half-step walk:** start on Clara's C and go up a half step, again and again -- every key, black and white -- to the next C. Count the steps, not the keys: 12 half steps. ☐

REMEMBER **A semitone is a half step: the very next key, black or white.**

STEP 2

A whole step: a tone

Two half steps make a **whole step**: **one key** sits in between. Its other name is a **tone**; American books say whole step. From C, step over the black key: D is a whole step up. Black keys too: two black keys with one white key between them are a whole step apart.



At the piano

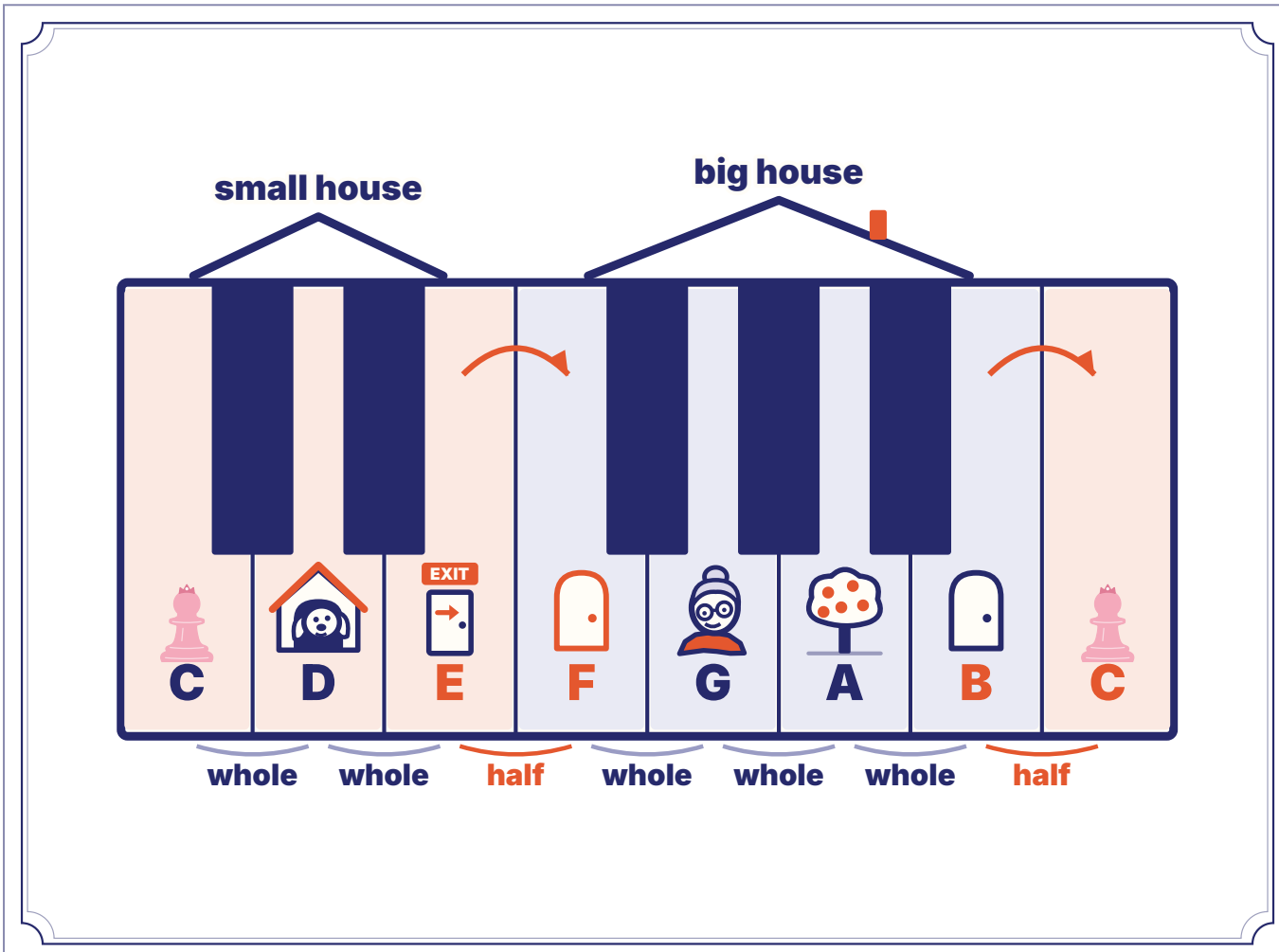
1. From C, play a whole step up: step over the black key and play D. Then play a whole step up from D: E. ☐
2. **Half or whole?** Play each pair and say "half step -- semitone" or "whole step -- tone": C D, E F, B C, F G, G♯ A♯, D♯ E. ☐

REMEMBER **A tone is a whole step: two half steps, one key in between.**

STEP 3

White half steps: E F and B C

Walk the white keys letter by letter (Chapter 3's steps) and look between them. Most letter steps have a black key in between: a **whole step**. But twice there is none. [B3] Walk out of the small house's **Exit (E)** and you are at the big house's **Front door (F)**; go out of the big house's **Back door (B)** and there is **Princess Clara (C)** at the next small house. **E F** and **B C** are only a **half step** apart.



At the piano

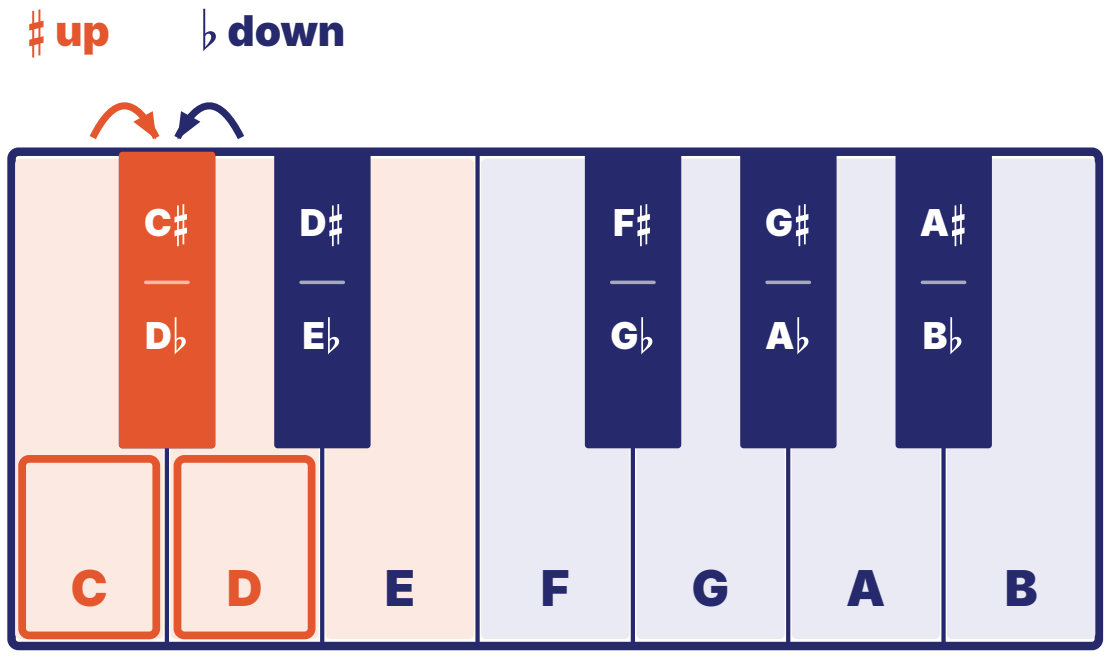
1. Find every E and F on the piano, then every B and C: no black key between them -- a half step. ☐
2. Walk up the white keys from C to the next C, naming each step: whole, whole, **half**, whole, whole, whole, **half**. ☐

REMEMBER **No black key between E F and B C: only a half step.**

STEP 4

Sharp and flat: one key, two names

Now the black keys get their names. B5 The **sharp sign ♯** moves a note **up a half step** -- to the very next key on the right. So the black key just right of C is **C sharp, C♯**. B5 The **flat sign ♭** moves a note **down a half step** -- to the very next key on the left. So the same black key, seen from D, is **D flat, D♭**. B4 One key, two names: a half step up from Clara's C, and a half step down from the Dog's D.



At the piano

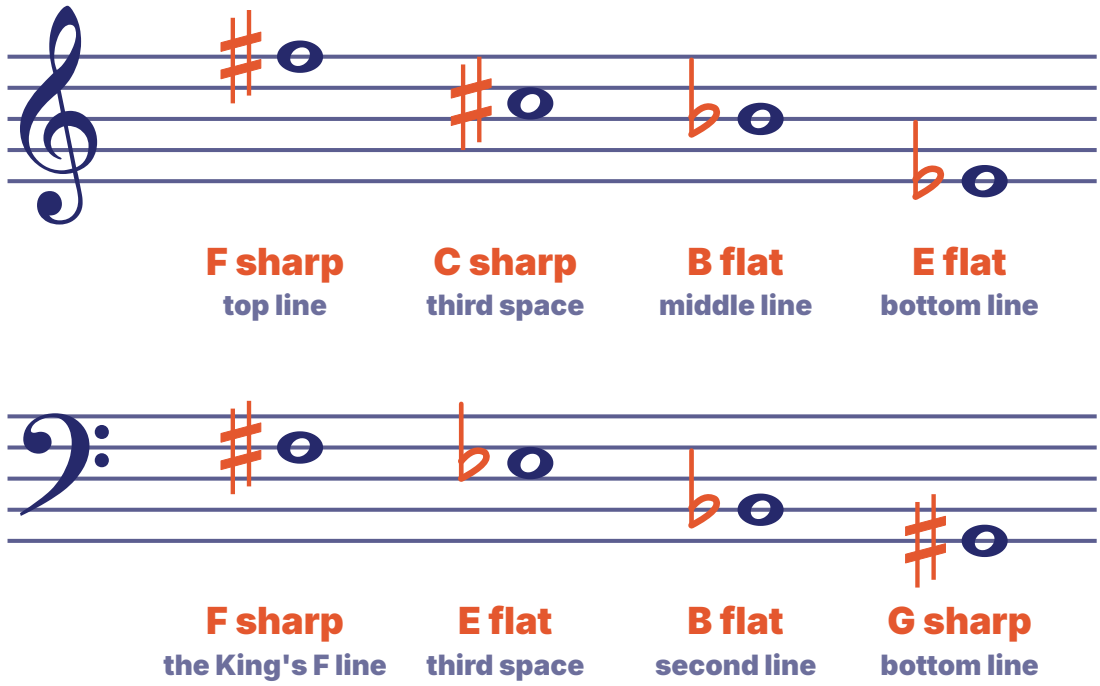
1. Play C, then C♯ -- a half step up. Play D, then D♭ -- a half step down. The same black key! ☐
2. Name every black key both ways: the small house C♯ = D♭, D♯ = E♭; the big house F♯ = G♭, G♯ = A♭, A♯ = B♭. ☐

REMEMBER **♯ up a half step, ♭ down a half step: one black key, two names.**

STEP 5

Sharps and flats on the staff

On the staff, the sign goes **just before the note**, on **the same line or space** as its head: the sharp's little box and the flat's round belly sit right on that line or space. Say the letter first, then the sign: "F sharp", "B flat". Write them the other way round: the sign first, then the note.



At the piano

- [ ] **1** Read and play Queensland's four notes with the right hand: F♯, C♯, B♭, E♭.
- [ ] **2** Read and play Kingsland's four with the left hand: F♯, E♭, B♭, G♯.

REMEMBER **The sign goes just before the note, on the note's own line or space.**

CHECK-UP

My five checks

Show each one at the piano, then tick how it is going -- not yet, nearly, or got it! The check-up on paper is in the Workbook.
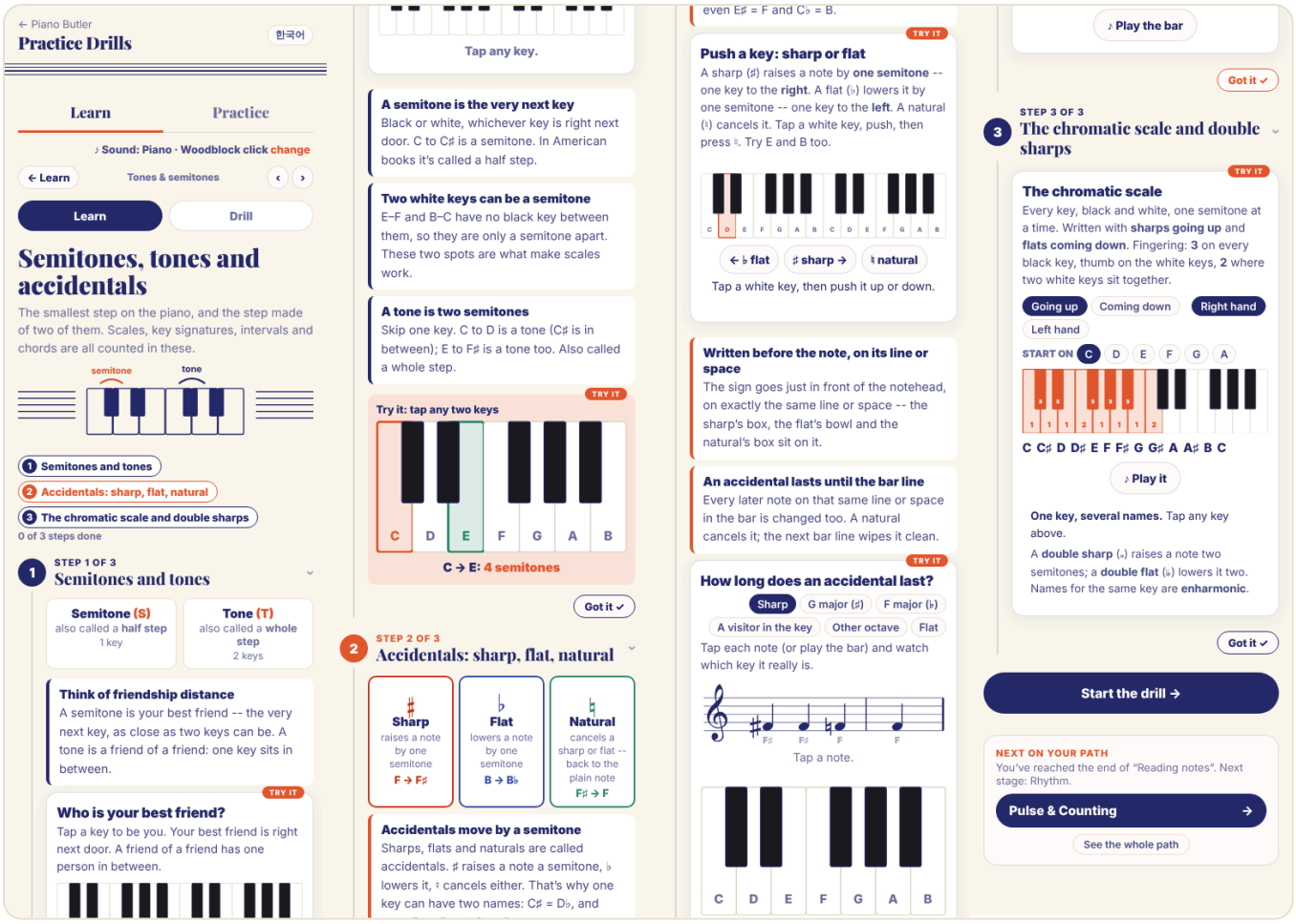
At the piano

	NOT YET	NEARLY	GOT IT!
 **I can play a half step (a semitone) up and down from any key**	○	◑	☆
 **I can play a whole step (a tone) up and down from any key**	○	◑	☆
 **I can show the white half steps: E F and B C**	○	◑	☆
 **I can name every black key two ways: C♯ = D♭**	○	◑	☆
 **I can read sharps and flats on the staff and play them**	○	◑	☆

Colour a circle each time it gets better: not yet, then nearly, then got it!

Today's online lesson, for comparison

The three steps today: semitones and tones (cards, tips, best friends, count the steps); accidentals (sharp, flat, natural, written before the note, until the bar line); the chromatic scale and double sharps.



Today's Workbook (Phase 298)

Six pages from before the Book rules: the opener, "Your map for this chapter", best friend or friend of a friend, what the signs do, the chromatic scale, and a scored check-up.

